Good and Bad User Interface Design Examples

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HCI



Bad User Interface Design Example



Bad interface aspect: Analogue portable radio

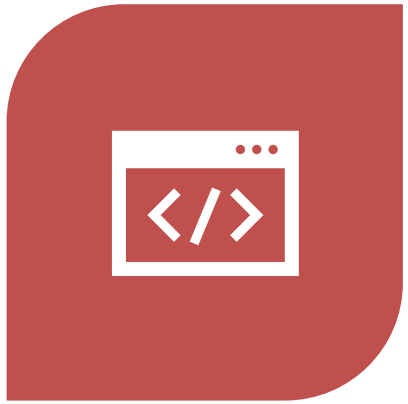
- Objective of the interface: allow its users to control the device and listen to a desired radio station.



Bad interface aspect: Analogue portable radio

- Problem: Finding the desired station may prove dificult due to a lack of information.
- The user may need to try frequencies and listen repeatedly to find the desired station.
- The issue is limited information — not the radio's small size.

Why is this aspect problematic ?



LIMITED VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS:

THE INTERFACE MAY NOT MAKE THE CURRENTLY SELECTED FREQUENCY SUFFICIENTLY CLEAR.



LIMITED FEEDBACK:

THE USER MAY NEED TO RELY ON THE SOUND BEING RECEIVED TO DETERMINE WHETHER THE TUNING ACTION PRODUCED THE INTENDED RESULT.



INEFFICIENT SEARCH:

FINDING A KNOWN STATION CAN REQUIRE MANUALLY SCANNING FREQUENCIES INSTEAD OF SELECTING IT DIRECTLY.

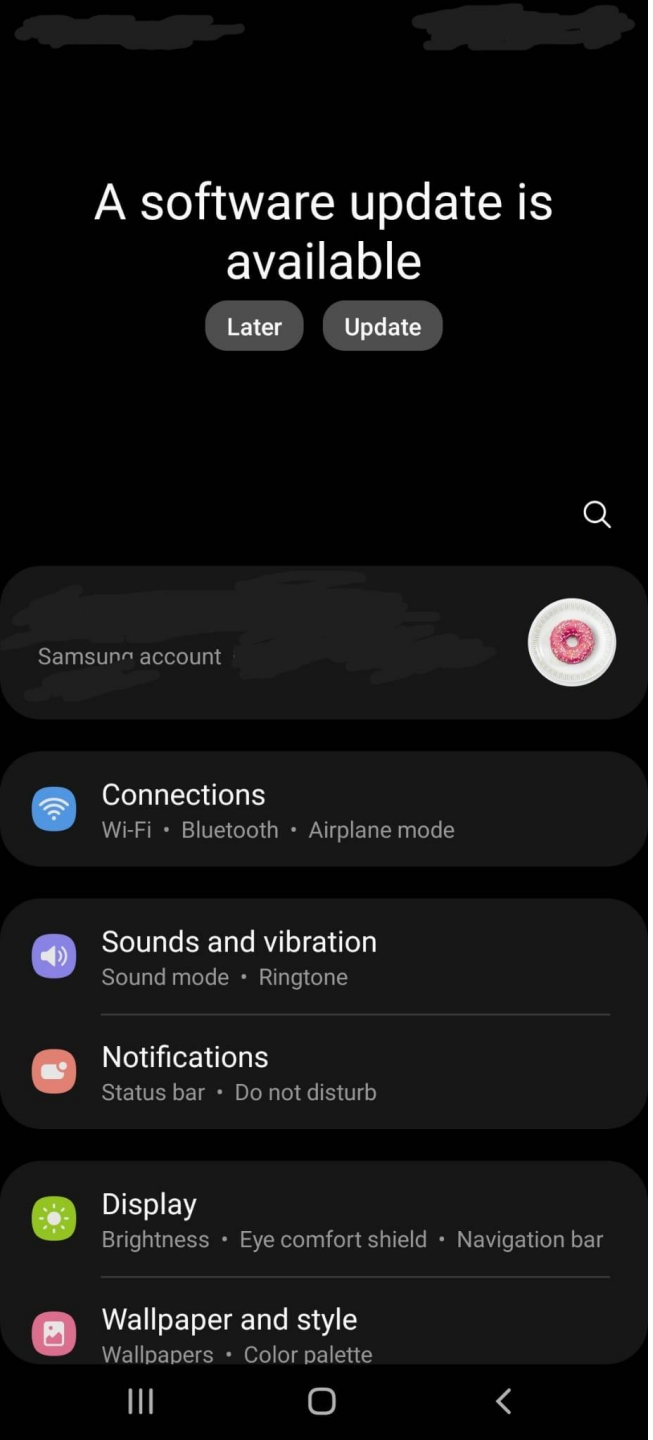
How could the radio be improved?

- - Add a clear digital display showing the exact frequency and station name.
- - Provide preset buttons so users can save and return to frequently used stations (like in cars).



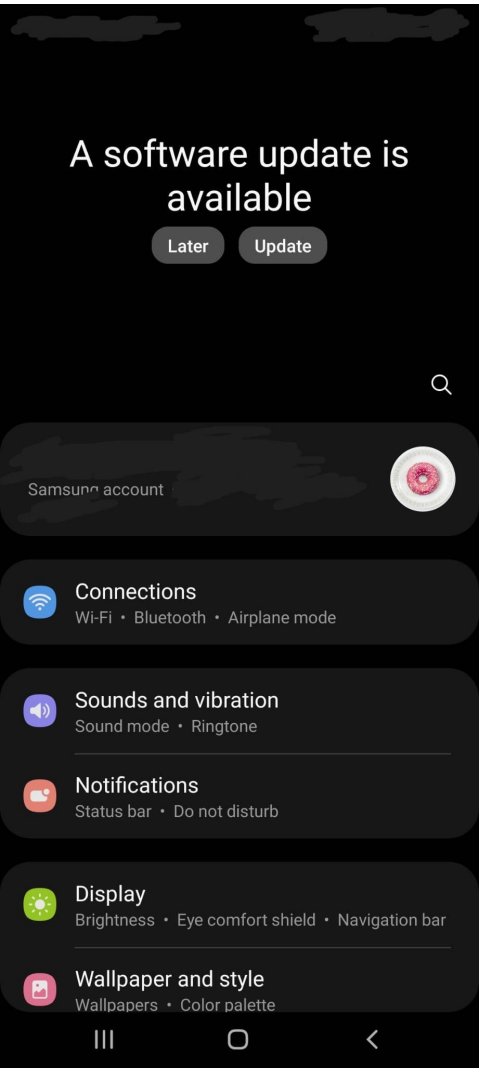
Fig 2 e 3 –
Radio System from an Opel Corsa 2004





Good User Interface Design Example

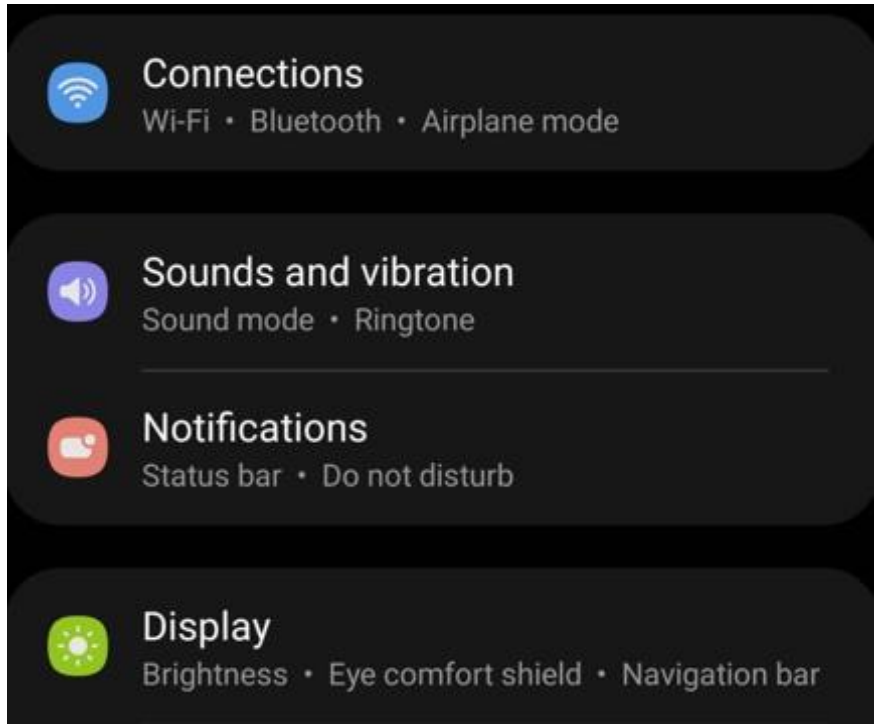
Good interface aspect: Phone(Samsung) Settings

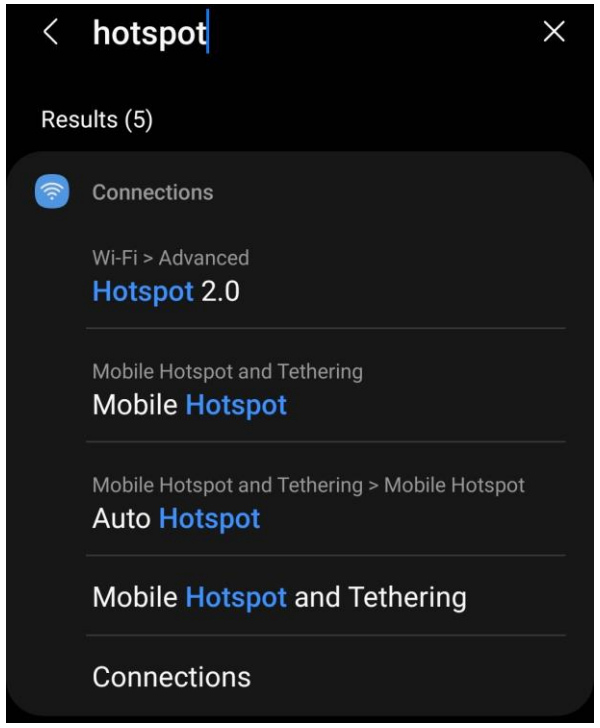


- Objective: Allow users to view and change the configurations of their smartphone.

Good interface aspect: Phone(Samsung) Settings

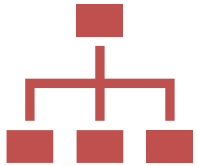
- The Samsung Settings application organizes its options into categories and subcategories.





- This gives the user a structure for exploring the available settings and a search bar which allows users to look for a specific option directly when they do not know which category contains it.

Why these aspects are effective?



Organization and grouping:

related settings are placed together, making the menu easier to navigate.



Recognition rather than recall:

category names such as Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Display, and Sound help users recognize the type of setting they need instead of having to remember an exact navigation path.



Search:

users can search for an option directly, providing an alternative to browsing through several menus.



Consistency:

the use of familiar menu structures and controls helps users understand how to interact with different settings.

Conclusion

- The radio example shows how limited status information can make a task slower and less certain.
- Samsung Settings supports navigation through grouping, recognizable labels and search.
- An interface should make relevant information visible and help users reach their goals.
- Both examples concern specific aspects, not a judgement that the entire product is good or bad.
- The comparison illustrates that interface quality depends on how well the design supports the user’s goals, makes relevant information visible, and helps users find and understand the available actions.